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Samsung Galaxy S5 Preview

By **Chaz Wilke**, Staff Writer

March 21, 2014

It's that time again. Time to dust off that crusty piece of plastic and metal you carry around with you everywhere. It's time to remember the [ridiculous amount of bacteria](#) on that 2-year-old phone of yours. It's time to fork over hundreds of dollars for a device that you "need." Samsung has announced it will release the Galaxy S5 to 150 countries April 11.

Catering to customers who once clamored at the prospect of having a full HD display in their pockets, the released specifications prove the shifting paradigm may be more in how the phone is used than what is under the hood. The S5 has garnered preview coverage similar to [CNET's take](#): "... the been-there, done-that design isn't novel enough to trample rivals the way Samsung might hope."

Let's take a look at what this new piece of communication hardware has in store for those looking to upgrade to the new hotness.

Overview

For those coming from the Samsung Galaxy S4, it's time to get excited for a smattering of incremental improvements! The S5's display is one tenth of an inch larger than its predecessor. This means a decisive victory for tech heads during those awkward phone to phone size comparison tests that often spring up in break rooms across the country.

The Galaxy S5's camera packs a 16 megapixel punch. The new camera is 3 megapixels superior to the S4's paltry 13 MP camera, although [early reviews](#) note little difference in the final image. The front-facing S5 camera boasts an impressive 2 megapixel count, which is significantly higher than the competing iPhone 5S' 1.2 MP front-facing camera. This should come as good news to the selfie community looking to improve the quality of their grainy brag photos.

Samsung's invasive TouchWiz interface wrapper that's forced on top of the core Android experience has also been given a facelift. Now resembling a far more stock Android experience than ever before, the TouchWiz's battery draining bloat appears to have been tailored more closely to Google's specifications due to a new agreement between the [two tech giants](#).

Bullet Point Features

Samsung has decided to include a heart-rate sensor located by the flash on the back of the unit. This allows for a mid-workout vitals check, but it requires the user to place his sweaty finger very close to the camera's lens. This new built-in feature is sure to be greeted as welcome news for the health conscious exercise-app-using consumer and also gives Samsung a leg up in the features race against the iPhone.

It's been reported that the front home button on the Galaxy S5 includes a fingerprint scanner to match the iPhone's Touch ID. This sensor can be used to unlock the phone as well as make purchases. It seems both

Samsung and Apple are banking on this becoming a new standard in mobile payments moving forward.

Samsung also boasts that the Galaxy S5 is highly water resistant. The official statement is the Galaxy S5 has an [International Protection Marking of IP67](#) where the phone has been tested to continue functioning after being submerged 1 meter for a total duration of 30 minutes. The Russian site hi-tech.mail.ru posted an early review of the new hardware. Preliminary testing found that the phone will not make calls under water but will continue to function, and then appears to remain entirely functional after [removal from the water](#).

Under the Hood

As for the new beating heart of the Galaxy S5, Samsung has included a 2.5 GHz quad-core Snapdragon 801 chipset. This is sure to please speed demons looking to have an incredibly fast processor in their pockets. As a comparison, the computer used to get mankind to the moon ran at [0.043MHz](#). This makes the new Samsung Galaxy S5 over 58,000 times more powerful than NASA's Apollo Guidance Computer from the summer of '69.

By pairing the ultra-fast 2.5 GHz processor with 2GB of RAM, Samsung hopes this will future-proof the phone for the foreseeable future or at least for the next two years, at which point early adopters will be ready to jump on the next hot phone.

Android gets an update as well. The Galaxy S5 comes preloaded with Android 4.4, nicknamed [KitKat](#). Some of the features ushered in with KitKat include: Chromecast support, built-in device management, a redesigned email app, additional control for location settings and more!

The Galaxy S5's battery has gotten a bump. It now sits at 2,800mAh, up from the S4's 2,600mAh. This means Galaxy S5 owners will have a projected 21 hours of talk time and 16 days of standby. There is often much hand waving when referring to mobile device battery life, but Samsung has projected its battery's life at double that of the iPhone 5S' 10 hours of talk time.

Samsung also hopes to help those who may have skipped a charge by implementing a new [Ultra Power Saving Mode](#), which hopes to double the life of a nearly depleted battery charge. This should come as welcome news to nearly everyone who's been faced with a sliver of a charge while making an important call.

Galaxy S5's [Download Booster](#) hopes to leverage both the included fifth-gen Wi-Fi 802.11ac support and LTE coverage to increase file download speed. Since many carriers have removed unlimited data, it would be advised to use this feature sparingly until you know the potential hidden cost of speedy downloads.

Shifting Paradigm

Another potential paradigm shift in how we use our phones is the advent of NFC (Near Field Communication), with which Samsung beats Apple to the market by including on the Galaxy S5. An evolution of the radio-frequency identification (RFID) that's already in any contemporary American passport, NFC may make our wallet obsolete as a repository for identifying cards like IDs and credit cards. With a simple wave from your Galaxy S5, the NFC-equipped phone you may soon allow you to pay for purchases at participating vendors. This comes as welcome news for those who contend with bulging wallets carrying everything from business card collections to three months of receipts.

Retailers will control the Galaxy S5's pricing. The new hot phone will be available stateside in charcoal, blue, gold and white at Best Buy, Amazon, Costco, RadioShack, Sam's Club, Target and Walmart on the carriers AT&T, Sprint, T-Mobile, Verizon Wireless, MetroPCS and U.S. Cellular.

[Direct Comparison](#)

Spec Comparison	Samsung Galaxy S5	iPhone 5S	Samsung Galaxy S4
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Size and Weight	142 x 72.5 x 8.1mm, 145g	123.8x58.6x7.6mm, 112g	136.6 x 69.8 x 7.9 mm, 130g
Screen Size	5.1 diagonal inches	4 diagonal inches	5.0 diagonal inches
Screen Resolution	1080 x 1920 pixels at 432 ppi	1136-by-640-pixel resolution at 326 ppi	1080 x 1920 pixels at 441 ppi
Camera	16 MP	8 MP	13 MP
Storage Capacity	16GB and 32GB expandable to 128GB via SD card slot	16GB, 32GB, 64GB	16GB expandable to 64GB via SD card slot
Battery	2,800mAh – Talk time 21 hours	1,560mAh – Talk time 10 hours	2,600mAh - Talk time 17 hours
Processor/Memory	2.5Ghz quad-core Snapdragon 801 chipset	1.3 GHz 64-bit A7 dual-core chip	1.9GHz quad-core Snapdragon 600 chipset

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BIO

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